

SELF-HEALING IN ISLAMIC SPIRITUALITY: Bridging Hamka's *Tafsir Al-Azhar* with Modern Psychological

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Abstract: The concept of self-healing has become a rapidly growing social discourse, in line with socio-cultural changes influenced by capitalism and technological advances. Capitalism encourages individuals to exceed physical and mental limits in pursuit of professional achievement, leading to accumulated stress and mental health disorders. On the other hand, technological advances have facilitated access to information that can exacerbate social comparisons. Although the term self-healing is often associated with temporary activities such as vacationing or shopping, these often only provide momentary happiness without delving into spiritual healing. This article examines the concept of self-healing in Hamka's *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, which integrates spiritual dimensions into religious practices such as *dhikr*, prayer, patience, and gratitude. This study uses a qualitative approach with textual analysis to link Hamka's understanding of spiritual healing with contemporary psychological concepts such as mindfulness, emotional regulation, and gratitude. The results of this study indicate that Hamka's approach to self-healing can build a dialogue between Islamic spirituality and modern psychological methods, opening up the potential for developing a more comprehensive and applicable approach to spiritual healing for contemporary Muslim communities.

Keywords: Self-healing, *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, Hamka, contemporary psychology, Islamic spirituality.

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Introduction

The concept of self-healing has emerged as a prominent societal discourse, largely due to the shifting sociocultural landscape characterized by the prevailing capitalist society. Capitalism is an economic system characterized by the pursuit of profit maximization. This phenomenon compels individuals to extend their physical and mental capacities beyond their natural limits in their professional endeavors. This phenomenon engenders an accumulation of stressors, compounded by the manifold demands on individuals' time and energy.

Moreover, advancements in technology have facilitated the dissemination of information, allowing individuals to disseminate content to a broad audience through social media platforms. This phenomenon facilitates the ease with which individuals can access information about others, thereby enabling the comparison of their own achievements with those of their peers.¹ These factors have been identified as contributing to the development of mental health disorders.

The term "self-healing" is frequently employed by the general populace to denote a state of rejuvenation, often associated with activities such as visiting the beach, embarking on a staycation, engaging in shopping, or attending cinematic screenings. A number of activities are associated with the term "self-healing." These activities are said to engender temporary happiness. When people engage in these activities, they temporarily set aside their problems or emotional wounds. This is a common misconception about self-healing.

To date, the discourse on self-healing has evolved predominantly within the domain of modern psychology, particularly within the paradigm of positive psychology. According to prominent figures in the field, such as Martin Seligman, the cultivation of practices like gratitude, mindfulness, and forgiveness is instrumental in enhancing an individual's emotional resilience and expediting the healing process

¹ Sherly Annavita Rahmi, "3 Tips Self-Healing: Terkendali dan Impactful | Ada apa? Eps. 30", video YouTube, 26 Maret 2022, <https://youtu.be/aDXmbKBDtOE>.

from psychological traumas.² Additionally, Jon Kabat-Zinn introduced mindfulness-based stress reduction as an effective technique for managing stress and anxiety.³ In the Indonesian context, studies such as those conducted by Sriwayuti et al. demonstrate that stress management practices have been proven to improve students' mental well-being.⁴ However, these approaches are largely rooted in Western and secular traditions and have not yet fully integrated into the spiritual framework of Indonesian Muslim society.

In the context of the expanding public cognizance of self-healing, which often gravitates toward ephemeral escape (hedonistic), there emerges a pressing imperative to re-examine the essence of self-healing from a more profound and transformative vantage point. One notable source in the field of Indonesian exegesis, *Tafsir Al-Azhar* by Hamka, incorporates a spiritual dimension that has the potential to serve as the conceptual foundation of self-healing in Islam.⁵ Employing a humanistic and Sufi approach to interpretation, Hamka elucidates verses from the Quran, including Q.S. al-Ra'd [13]: 28, Q.S. al-Baqarah [2]: 45 and 153, and Q.S. Ibrāhīm [14]: 7, within the framework of the inner experience of humans seeking peace and tranquility of the soul. This prompts a fundamental epistemological inquiry: to what extent can Hamka's interpretation of these verses be conceptualized as a model of Islamic self-healing that is compatible with contemporary psychological methodologies? The present study seeks to explore the relationship between spiritual activities, such as *dhikr*, patience, *shukr* (gratitude), and *ṣalāh* (prayer) in Hamka's interpretation, and contemporary psychological concepts, including mindfulness, gratitude, and emotional regulation.

² Martin E. P. Seligman, *Authentic Happiness* (New York: Free Press, 2002).

³ Jon Kabat-Zinn, *Wherever You Go, There You Are: Mindfulness Meditation in Everyday Life* (Hyperion, 1994).

⁴ Wahyuni, S., M. Hitami, dan M. Afandi, "Metode Manajemen Stres untuk Meningkatkan Kesejahteraan Siswa (Studi Literatur Sistematis)," *Psikobuletin: Buletin Ilmiah Psikologi* 3, no. 1 (2022): 45-63, <http://dx.doi.org/10.24014/pib.v3i1.15719>.

⁵ M.A.F. Badawi, "The Relevance of Muhammad Abduh's Thought in Indonesian Tafsir; Analysis of Tafsir Al-Azhar," *Millah: Journal of Religious Studies* 21, no. 1 (2021): 113-48, <https://doi.org/10.20885/millah.vol21.iss1.art5>.

According to the aforementioned framework, the objective of this study is to elaborate on the concept of self-healing in Hamka's *Tafsir Al-Azhar* by underscoring the spiritual dimensions inherent in worship practices such as *dhikr*, prayer, patience, and gratitude. The present study aims to elucidate how Hamka comprehends and articulates these values within an Islamic framework. Additionally, it seeks to examine the relevance of these values to the self-healing approach in modern psychology. The objective of this study is to establish a connection between Sufi-infused Quranic exegesis and a scientific framework for spiritual healing. The study proposes an integrative model that can be utilized to develop a more comprehensive, profound, and practical understanding of self-healing for contemporary muslim communities.

Self-Healing: The Art of Controlling Emotions

The term “self-healing” is a combination of the words “self” meaning oneself, and “healing” which means recovery or restoration. Consequently, the term “self-healing” is employed to denote the process of healing oneself. According to the Cambridge Dictionary, healing is defined as a process of restoring, restoring health, or ending a bad situation on an emotional level.⁶ Tchiki Davis, the founder of The Berkeley Well-Being Institute, conceptualizes self-healing as the process of recuperating from emotional and mental distress, including but not limited to trauma, stress, anxiety, and depression.⁷ Self-healing, therefore, is defined as the process of healing the heart or soul to restore the energy within oneself, particularly in terms of mental and emotional well-being.

Self-healing is closely related to psychology because self-healing is related to the mind or psyche. The human brain is comprised of three distinct layers, namely the reptilian brain (brain stem), the mammalian brain (limbic system), and the human brain (neocortex). The amygdala, a component of the limbic system, has been identified

⁶ “Healing”, *Cambridge Dictionary* <https://dictionary.cambridge.org/dictionary/english/healing>. Diakses pada 9 Juli 2022.

⁷ Rahmi, “3 Tips Self-Healing”, <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aDXmbKBDtOE>.

as a critical region for the genesis of diverse emotional responses, with profound implications for the psyche.⁸

From a psychological perspective, the concept of self-healing involves two fundamental elements: first, the necessity for individuals to direct their attention inward, and second, the identification of internal factors that give rise to mental or psychological disorders. Subsequently, it is imperative for individuals to assume complete self-control, thereby fostering an acceptance of their deficiencies and missteps. Upon attaining this stage, subjects have been known to experience a sense of inner peace and tranquility. This constitutes the fundamental principle of self-healing from a psychological vantage point.

Conversely, Islam perceives self-healing as a process that is more oriented towards the human soul. The soul (*nafs*) occupies a pivotal role within the self, exercising comprehensive authority over the full spectrum of a person's potential. The soul is comprised of two instruments: the mind, which functions as a tool for recognizing everything that happens in a logical context, and the heart, which is related to the feelings and emotions needed to understand all information involving sensitivity. The state of being healthy and calm is characterized by a state of harmony between the mind and the heart.⁹ Islamic doctrine delineates the soul according to its inherent qualities and propensities. The concept of the soul is multifaceted, with several aspects contributing to its complex nature.¹⁰ One such aspect is *al-nafs al-ammārah bi al-sū'*, which can be translated as the urge of the soul to engage in malevolent actions. Another aspect is *al-nafs al-lawwāmah*, which refers to the capacity of the soul to experience regret for transgressions or sins. The third aspect is *al-nafs al-muṭma'innah*, also known as the tranquil soul, which is

⁸ Angelina Rosmawati, *The Miracle of Self Healing* (Yogyakarta: Bintang Semesta Media, 2022), 59.

⁹ Santoso dkk, "Harmonisasi Al-Ruh, Al-Nafs, Al-Hawa dalam Psikologi Islam", *Islamika* 3, no. 1 (2020), 173-174, <https://doi.org/10.37859/jsi.v3i1.1899>.

¹⁰ Lajnah Pentashihan Mushaf Al-Qur'an, *Fenomena Kejiwaan Manusia dalam Perspektif Al-Qur'an dan Sains* (Jakarta: Kementerian Agama RI, 2016), 25.

characterized by a state of freedom from doubt and malevolent deeds.¹¹ The ultimate objective of Islamic self-healing is situated at the level of *al-nafs al-muṭma'innah*. The pursuit of inner peace is often associated with the practice of monotheistic worship, particularly the worship of Allah, and the constant remembrance of Him.

Hamka and Islamic Therapy for the Soul: Self-Healing through Remembrance and Devotion

From a religious perspective, self-healing is defined as a method of healing emotional wounds through spiritual activities that promote mental tranquility. In his exegesis, Hamka further asserts that the most efficacious form of spiritual healing is any method or therapy that fosters peace within the soul. Hamka's statement is consistent with the findings of Muharini Aulia, who cited research published in *the Asian Journal of Psychiatry*. This journal conducted a study on the mental health of patients infected with SARS-CoV-2 during periods of self-isolation. The journal elucidates that the subjects' primary method of alleviating stress during their period of isolation was through the act of recalling God (or Allah, as the case may be). According to the Islamic holy book, the Quran, specifically Surah al-Ra'd [13]: 28, the act of remembrance of Allah (God) has been associated with a sense of inner peace.¹² The following list contains a selection of activities for the remembrance of Allah that are mentioned in the *Tafsir Al-Azhar*:

1. *Dhikr*

Dhikr is defined as the act of remembering Allah. The fundamental principle of self-healing is the attainment of inner peace, and *dhikr* is a spiritual practice that has been shown to facilitate this state of being. From a linguistic perspective, the term "*dhikr*" is derived

¹¹ Zulfatmi, "*al-Nafs* dalam Al-Qur'an (Analisis Term *al-Nafs* sebagai Dimensi Psikis Manusia)," *Jurnal Mudarrisuna* 10, no. 2 (2020), 49, DOI: <http://dx.doi.org/10.22373/jm.v10i2.7838>.

¹² Muharini Aulia, "Psikologi Salat: Salat Khusyuk Bikin Rileks | Ustadzah Muharini Aulia | Filosofi Salat", video YouTube, 18 Januari 2022, <https://youtu.be/TRkoh7AiuPQ>.

from the word “*dhakara*” which can be translated as “to remember,” “to reminisce,” or “to mention.” M. Quraish Shihab offers a dual interpretation of the term “*dhikr*,” delineating two distinct meanings. In its narrow sense, *dhikr* refers to the act of remembering that is performed exclusively with the tongue. In its broadest sense, *dhikr* encompasses the mention of Allah’s names, His praise, and any act that pertains to Him, accompanied by the presence of the heart.¹³

Dhikr is defined as an activity that encourages the perpetual remembrance of Allah. Common forms of *dhikr* include the recital of Allah’s names, the expression of praise for Him, and the enumeration of His attributes. Nevertheless, the true potency of *dhikr* resides in its recital with profound emotional resonance, a phenomenon referred to as “*kalbu*.” A medical expert from Harvard University, Herbert Benson, has demonstrated through his research that specific mantras in Islam, known as *dhikr*, which are recurrent formulas recited repeatedly, have the capacity to promote healing for various illnesses.¹⁴

In the Islamic tradition, *dhikr* occupies a significant place, as evidenced by the accounts recorded in *Ṣaḥīḥ Muslim* from Abū Sa’īd al-Khudrī and Abū Hurayrah. These sources report that the Prophet Muhammad declared that individuals who perpetually contemplate Allah will be encircled by angels and experience a sense of inner tranquility.¹⁵ The aforementioned statement in the Hadith lends support to the interpretation of Surah al-Ra’d [13]: 28 in the book *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, which states: According to the principles of religious studies, the act of recalling or thinking about God has been shown to engender feelings of tranquility.¹⁶ This state of calm has been observed to be accompanied by the dissipation of a wide range of emotional distress, including anxiety, confusion, despair, fear, worry, doubt, and sorrow.

¹³ M. Quraish Shihab, *Wawasan Al-Al-Qur’an tentang Zikir dan Doa* (Tangerang: Lentera Hati, 2018), 4.

¹⁴ “Berzikir Dapat Meningkatkan Kemampuan Genetik Melawan Penyakit”, Rumah Sakit Universitas Airlangga, 22 Mei 2013, <http://rumahsakit.unair.ac.id>.

¹⁵ Abū Zakariā Yahya b. Sharaf al-Nawawī, *al-Adhkār al-Muntakhabah min Kalām Sayyid al-Abrār*, terj. Farid Abdul Aziz Qurusy (Jakarta: Bee Media Pustaka, 2021), 31.

¹⁶ Abdul Malik Karim Amrullah (selanjutnya ditulis Hamka), *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, vol. 4 (Singapura: Pustaka Nasional Pte Ltd, 1982), 3761.

This notion underscores the close association between remembrance of God, or *dhikr*, and self-healing, as both aim to achieve the same ultimate objective: the peace and tranquility of the soul.

From a psychological perspective, *dhikr* therapy can be defined as a method of stimulating the mind and heart to remember Allah in everyday life.¹⁷ Subandi expounds on the notion that *dhikr* therapy engenders novel perceptual frameworks that in turn give rise to convictions that exert a predominant influence on an individual's cognitive landscape.¹⁸ These convictions encompass the notion that Allah's assistance is a tangible entity capable of ameliorating various afflictions that perturb the mind or exert a dominative influence over the brain. Furthermore, *dhikr* exerts a significant impact on the brain by stimulating activity in the hypothalamus, thereby preventing the production of corticotropin-releasing factor (CRF) and inhibiting the secretion of adrenocorticotrophic hormone (ACTH) in the anterior pituitary gland. This inhibition has been demonstrated to affect the production of cortisol, adrenaline, and noradrenaline. This condition induces a state of calm in the body, characterized by stable blood pressure and a normal heart rate.¹⁹

In order for *dhikr* to exert a positive influence on an individual, it is imperative to comprehend the appropriate manner or etiquette of *dhikr* to Allah. In his book *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, Hamka expounds on the correct guidance for *dhikr*, as interpreted through the lens of Surah al-A'raf [7]: 205 of the Quran. In his exegesis of the verse, he elucidates that four aspects must be considered when engaging in *dhikr*,²⁰ namely: The first aspect of *dhikr* is to engage in contemplation of the power and greatness of Allah with profound sincerity, involving one's entire being. The second aspect involves the remembrance of Allah with humility,

¹⁷ Puti Febriana Niko, "Pengaruh Terapi Dzikir untuk Menurunkan Kecemasan pada Ibu Hamil," *ISLAMIKA* 1, no. 1 (2018), 27.

¹⁸ Subandi, *Psikologi Dzikir: Studi Fenomenologi Pengalaman Transformasi Religius* (Yogyakarta: Pustaka Pelajar, 2009), 240.

¹⁹ Ummul Khasanah Eka Rahmawati, "Pengaruh Dzikir terhadap Mekanisme Koping Pasien Post Operasi Open Prostatectomy di Bangsal Alamanda 1 RSUD Sleman Yogyakarta" (Skripsi, STIKES 'Aisyiyah, Yogyakarta, 2015), 9.

²⁰ Hamka, *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, vol. 4, 2672.

which entails a state of self-abnegation before the divine. The third aspect is the remembrance of Allah with a profound sense of awe, recognizing the potential consequences of disobeying or neglecting the divine, such as the loss of blessings, favors, or divine assistance. It is imperative to emphasize that the act of remembering Allah should not be accompanied by excessive noise or shouting. This is attributed to the fact that Allah is All-Hearing. It is evident that, irrespective of the manner in which *dhikr* is expressed, whether vocally or internally, Allah's capacity to perceive it remains unimpeded. Furthermore, the designated space for *dhikr* should be characterized by tranquility and cleanliness. This is a significant gesture of respect toward the deity being commemorated, specifically Allah, the singular and omnipotent entity.²¹

2. *Ṣalāh*

Prayer in Arabic is referred to as *ṣalāh*, which translates to “supplication.” According to the most precise technical definition, the term refers to a series of acts of worship that are performed in a specific manner and with specific requirements in accordance with Islamic law. The series begins with the *takbīr* and ends with the recitation of the *salām*.²² Prayer serves as a means of establishing a connection between a servant and his Lord. The practice of prayer has been shown to foster a sense of spiritual connection and proximity to Allah. This practice is believed to bestow numerous blessings and promote inner peace for those who engage in it.

In the following discourse, Hamka offers an interpretation of Surah al-Baqarah [2]: 45. According to Islamic belief, the number 45 is associated with the concept of *ṣalāh*, which is considered to have the power to purify both the heart and the soul. This purification, in turn, is believed to result in the establishment of inner peace for the individual. Furthermore, in his exegesis of Surah Hūd [11]: 114 in the eleventh chapter, Hamka elucidates an additional facet of the art of

²¹ Al-Nawawī, *Al-Adhkār al-Muntakhabah*, 35.

²² Ibnu Watiniyah, *Kitab Lengkap Salat, Shalawat, Zikir, dan Doa* (Jakarta: Kaysa Media, 2017), 42.

performing *ṣalāh*. The performance of the five daily prayers is regarded as the zenith of religious devotion. Consequently, if an individual has already committed missteps, engaging in the five daily prayers has the potential to counteract the repercussions of these missteps, thereby fostering a gradual shift in disposition, characterized by heightened fervor and enthusiasm for the performance of virtuous deeds. As time progresses, the impact of these missteps will gradually diminish, as a result of the consistent undertaking of virtuous actions.²³

In his tafsir, Hamka offers an explanation regarding the interpretation of the Qur'an surah Hūd [11]. This value of 114 is consistent with the psychological rationale underpinning the benefits of the prostration position during prayer. In an online seminar entitled "The Power of Self-Healing," Aisah Dahlan expounded on the notion that when an individual assumes the prostration position, blood flows expeditiously to the brain, specifically to the prefrontal cortex (a region implicated in intellectual functions, including knowledge and skill acquisition), the parietal lobe (associated with personality and aptitude), and the crown of the head (considered the seat of error and dishonesty). This cerebral circulation supplies the prefrontal cortex and the parietal lobe with nutrients, minerals, and vitamins, while simultaneously purging the crown of the head of errors and falsehoods. Moreover, prostration has been demonstrated to facilitate the purification of the amygdala from detrimental emotional influences.²⁴

In the Quran, Surah al-Baqarah [2]: 45, according to Islamic belief, it is considered essential to maintain a serious and reflective demeanor during the performance of *salah*, or prayer. Hamka elucidates the notion of "seman" as a state of spiritual submission to Allah, characterized by a profound awareness of one's own insignificance in the grand scheme of things and a steadfast belief in the inevitable return to Allah's divine presence.²⁵ Concurrently, 'Ali b.

²³ Amrullah, *Tafsir al-Azhar*, vol. 6, 3563.

²⁴ Draisahdahlan, "The Power of Self-Healing – dr. Aisah Dahlan, CMHt., CM.NLP", YoutTbe, 3 November 2022, <https://www.youtube.com/live/3cokEzgwbNM?feature=share>.

²⁵ Hamka, *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, vol. 9, 7179.

Abī Ṭalḥah, who transmitted the tradition from Ibn ‘Abbās, interpreted the word *khāshī‘ūn* as denoting the disposition of an individual who reveres Allah and is imbued with a sense of composure.²⁶ According to Surah al-Mu‘minūn [23]: 2, *khushū‘* is an essential component of *ṣalāh*, defined as “prayer that has an impact.” According to Ibn Kathīr’s *tafsīr*, the state of *khushū‘* in *ṣalāh* is only attainable through the following three practices: the focus of one’s heart during *ṣalāh*, the active engagement in *ṣalāh*, and the complete dissociation from all worldly concerns, thereby prioritizing *ṣalāh*.²⁷

The act of praying with profound devotion is widely regarded as a formidable challenge to undertake. Often, prayers performed amidst busy schedules are merely done as a duty and seem rushed. Moreover, during the performance of prayers, it is challenging for an individual to concentrate their heart and mind on Allah, as their thoughts remain preoccupied with worldly concerns. Consequently, it is imperative to cultivate a sense of solemnity in *ṣalāh* and to temporarily set aside worldly concerns. One method of training oneself to maintain a sense of solemnity during *ṣalāh* is to develop a comprehensive understanding of the recitations associated with this ritual. By doing so, one can facilitate the absorption and appreciation of these recitations, thereby fostering an internal dialogue that encompasses both praise and conversation with Allah. This practice enables individuals to concentrate their thoughts and emotions on remembrance of Allah.

3. Patience

The term “patience” is commonly defined as the act of restraining oneself. Patience, in its broadest sense, can be defined as the act of self-restraint in the face of disliked circumstances, such as the exertion of effort to resist personal desires during the performance of acts of worship directed towards the One and Only God. This entails the restraint of one’s inclinations toward sinful actions and the

²⁶ Ibn Kathīr, *Tafsīr Ibnu Katsir*, vol. 18, terj. Bahrūn Abu Bakar (Bandung: Sinar Baru Algensindo, 2004), 7.

²⁷ *Ibid.*, 8.

fortitude to persevere through life's vicissitudes, thereby averting the inclination to relinquish or harbor animosity toward divine decree. This perspective aligns with the interpretation outlined in the book *Tafsir al-Munir* concerning Surah al-Baqarah [2]. According to verse 45, it is imperative to exercise patience in order to resist the inclinations that motivate individuals to engage in sinful acts.²⁸ Patience, therefore, fosters a state of inner peace, as it enables an individual to focus exclusively on Allah. Consequently, even the most arduous of trials become manageable, due to the constant remembrance of the Almighty.

This interpretation is derived from the analysis of Surah al-Baqarah [2]: 153. In *Tafsir Al-Azhar*, Hamka's perspective on patience is an essential attitude to cultivate for oneself, with its implementation being paramount in all daily circumstances, particularly when confronted with adversity or tribulations. Hamka further asserts that patience is instrumental in mitigating feelings of anxiety or restlessness, thereby fostering a sense of inner peace. This is due to the fact that, through patience, an individual becomes prepared to accept Allah's decisions and seek solutions to the difficulties they face in a calm manner.

Patience is a mental factor that exerts a significant influence on the soul.²⁹ This perspective aligns with the assertions put forth by M. Utsman Najati, who contends that patience serves as a crucial indicator of mental well-being. This is due to the fact that patience instills in us the ability to confront life's challenges and to maintain our resolve in the face of adversity.³⁰

Statements related to patience have been shown to engender feelings of calmness and peace of mind, a phenomenon that is also confirmed by psychological discipline. Andri posits that the human mind is capable of engendering stress due to the amygdala's propensity

²⁸ Wahbah al-Zuhayli, *Tafsir Al-Munir*, vol. 1, terj. Abdul Hayyie al-Kattani dkk (Jakarta: Gema Insani, 2013), 117.

²⁹ Ibid., 300.

³⁰ Muhammad Utsman Najati, *Hadits dan Ilmu Jiwa*, terj. Zaka alfarizi (Bandung: Pustaka, 2005), 312.

to generate an excess of negative perceptions. These cognitive processes, shaped by internal mental factors, can give rise to a range of adverse emotional responses, including anxiety, restlessness, and other negative emotions. Addressing and reducing these perceptions necessitates patience and sincerity.³¹

Furthermore, Hamka explicitly acknowledged the complexity of applying patience in real-world contexts. This is due to the fact that patience is regarded as a virtue of significant importance in Islam. Indeed, the Quran explicitly states that Allah will always be with those who are patient. This assertion is further substantiated by a Hadith recorded by Abū Saʿīd al-Khudrī, which asserts that Allah is perpetually satisfied with an individual who endeavors to embody patience.³²

Patience is defined as a behavior or practice based on faith in God.³³ Consequently, individuals who possess the capacity for patience must also have unwavering and complete faith in God, recognizing that all events are divinely ordained. Consequently, individuals who adeptly cultivate their souls through patience can enhance their spiritual well-being and sustain optimal mental health.

4. *Shukr*

The Arabic word “*shukr*” is commonly translated as “grateful” or “thankful.” In *Munawwir*, *shukr* signifies gratitude, commendation, or satiation. Meanwhile, the term *syukur*, as defined in the *Kamus Besar Bahasa Indonesia (Great Dictionary of the Indonesian Language)*, encompasses the concepts of gratitude towards Allah, expressing thankfulness, and giving thanks.³⁴

³¹ Andri Psikosomatik, “Ikhlās, Sabar, Sadar Membantu Kurangi Stres dan Cemas Tanpa Obat”, Youube, 2 Juli 2021, <https://youtu.be/Vf5QrB6fbsM>.

³² Khalid Basalamah Official, “Karakteristik Mereka yang Dicintai Allah – Orang-Orang yang Sabar”, video YouTube, 18 Juni 2021, <https://youtu.be/kfW6hUDjibI>.

³³ Al-Haj Maulana Fazlul-Karim, *Imam Ghazali's Ihya Ulum-Id-Din Edisi Inggris*, terj. Purwanto (Bandung: Marja, 2019), 23.

³⁴ M. Quraish Shihab, *Wawasan Al-Qur'an* (Bandung: Mizan, 1996), 213.

The act of expressing gratitude is a method for maintaining remembrance of Allah. This is consistent with the explicit wording in Surah al-Baqarah [2]: 152:

فَاذْكُرُونِي أَذْكُرْكُمْ وَاشْكُرُوا لِي وَلَا تَكْفُرُونِ

Remember Me; I will remember you. And thank Me, and never be ungrateful.³⁵

The analysis of the verse's linguistic nuances suggests a correlation between *shukr* and *dhikr*, implying a potential interdependence between these concepts. Consequently, gratitude has been demonstrated to engender a state of emotional tranquility, serving as a constructive approach to address psychological afflictions and emotional maladies.

In his *tafsir*, Hamka posits that gratitude to Allah is conducive to an augmentation of blessings bestowed upon the individual. Furthermore, it has been demonstrated to exert an influence on an individual's emotional state, engendering feelings of contentment. The expression of gratitude for divine blessings is a hallmark of an individual who has attained a state of spiritual fulfillment. Such individuals experience a perpetual sense of contentment, derived from the awareness of their spiritual endowments. Conversely, the absence of gratitude for Allah's blessings can engender a sense of deficiency, which may manifest as illness, poverty, fear, or anxiety.³⁶

The aforementioned literature suggests that gratitude plays a significant role in the healing of emotional wounds and the maintenance of mental health. This perspective aligns with Sayyid Quṭb's interpretation of Surah Ibrāhīm [14]: 7, which asserts that gratitude serves as an indicator of the rectitude of the human soul.³⁷ Additionally, Sayyid Quṭb posits that gratitude engenders numerous

³⁵ Kementerian Agama RI, *Al-Qur'an dan Terjemahannya: Edisi Penyempurnaan 2019* (Jakarta: Lajnah Pentashihan Mushaf Al-Qur'an Badan Litbang dan Diklat Kementerian Agama RI, 2019), 31.

³⁶ M. Quraish Shihab, *Tafsir Al-Mishbah: Pesan, Kesan, dan Keserasian Al-Qur'an*, vol. 7 (Jakarta: Lentera Hati 2002), 23.

³⁷ Sayyid Quṭb, *Tafsir Fi Zhilalil Qur'an*, terj. Abdul Hayyie al-Kattani dkk. (Jakarta: Gema Insani Press. 2003), 84.

benefits for humanity, including the purification of the soul, encouragement to engage in righteous deeds and utilize blessings in a proper manner, the induction of joy and contentment in others, and the enhancement of various social relationships within society.³⁸

Al-Rāghib al-Iṣfahānī offers a definition of gratitude as an expression in the mind related to blessings, and he further elaborates on its outward manifestation.³⁹ This perspective aligns with the assertion of M. Quraish Shihab, who posits that the fundamental essence of gratitude entails the utilization of blessings in accordance with divine directives and the invocation of the Giver of Blessings by His hallowed names.⁴⁰ Conversely, Ibn Qayyim expounds on the notion that a grateful individual must possess five fundamental qualities: submission of the heart to Allah, love for Allah, acknowledgment of the blessings He has bestowed, calling upon or praising Him for all His blessings, and abstaining from utilizing those blessings for activities that Allah has prohibited.⁴¹ The expression of gratitude can be articulated through a variety of means, including but not limited to heartfelt sentiment, verbal articulation, and tangible actions.

The concept of gratitude, when expressed from a spiritual perspective, encompasses the recognition that all blessings originate from Allah, signifying His grace, benevolence, and munificence. The experience of genuine gratitude has been shown to facilitate the recognition and appreciation of blessings in one's life. This emotional state has been found to be associated with a heightened sense of gratitude towards Allah, the Islamic god, and a tendency to maintain this sentiment over time.⁴²

The practice of verbal gratitude entails the expression of profound appreciation for Allah's blessings, accompanied by sincere

³⁸ Ibid.

³⁹ Firdaus, "Syukur dalam Perspektif Al-Qur'an," *Jurnal Mimbar* 5, no. 1 (2019), 61, DOI: <https://doi.org/10.47435/mimbar.v5i1.378>.

⁴⁰ Shihab, *Tafsir Al-Mishbah*, 23.

⁴¹ 'Abd Allāh b. Ṣāliḥ al-Fawzan, *Kayfa Nakūna min al-Shākirīn*, terj. Hedi Fajar Rahadian (Bandung: Marja, 2016), 14-15.

⁴² Ibid., 39.

adoration, as a means of acknowledging and recognizing the gifts bestowed upon them. The expression of gratitude verbally is comprised of two distinct meanings. The first aspect entails the description of Allah with attributes such as generosity, glory, goodness, and mercy, which are considered to be among His perfect attributes. The second aspect involves gratitude, which is expressed through the acknowledgment of His blessings and the dissemination of this knowledge to one's surroundings or loved ones. This dissemination serves to underscore the notion that these blessings originate from Allah and to demonstrate His mercy for the blessings one has received.⁴³ The second meaning can be implemented with the proviso that it does not result in harm. For instance, when attempting to articulate the concept of blessings to one's intimate circle, it becomes evident that doing so would engender feelings of envy among others.

Additionally, the act of *shukr* can be performed through the use of body parts or deeds that facilitate proximity to obedience to God Almighty, rather than engaging in all the deeds that He disapproves of. For instance, the practice of devout worship, the maintenance of optimal physical well-being through the regulation of healthy sleep patterns, the act of sharing with those in need, the completion of food items that have been procured, and the utilization of smartphones for constructive purposes, among others. Furthermore, humans are capable of recognizing the profound value of their five senses, which are in optimal working order.

The Relevance of Hamka's Self-Healing Method with the Self-Healing Method in Psychology

Following a thorough examination of Hamka's concept of self-healing, its implications for Islam from Hamka's perspective will be explored, along with its applications in psychology. The following are some of the relevant points and explanations.

⁴³ Ibid., 41.

1. The Relevance of *Dhikr* and Mindfulness

Dhikr is defined as the act of mentioning Allah with praises for Him, performed with maximum frequency and without any restrictions on time or place. This practice is undertaken with the objective of fostering remembrance of Allah and cultivating a profound understanding of His omnipotence and grandeur. *Dhikr* is a term used to denote a process of self-reflection and introspection that is believed to facilitate a comprehensive awareness of one's own insignificance and reliance on divine mercy. The practice is said to encourage individuals to acknowledge Allah as the supreme creator of the universe, encompassing its intricate complexity, and as the ultimate authority over all events that transpire within the temporal realm.

It is imperative for all individuals to acknowledge their insignificance as mere creatures of God. By comprehending this, individuals will develop an understanding of their limitations, recognizing that proficiency in all domains is not necessary, that setbacks are an inherent aspect of growth, and that external factors can influence outcomes beyond their control. Consequently, individuals will find it more feasible to compromise with their thoughts, not to demand too much of themselves beyond their capabilities, and to accept themselves as they are. This process fosters mental and emotional tranquility.

Dhikr bears a resemblance to one method of self-healing, namely mindfulness. Mindfulness can be defined as a technique for taking time to focus on what is happening now without judging what is happening and being fully aware of oneself. Consequently, *dhikr* and mindfulness techniques have the potential to facilitate complete self-awareness, particularly with regard to one's personal deficiencies.

Furthermore, there are notable parallels in the manner in which these two techniques are employed. Indeed, *dhikr* can be performed in a variety of locations and is not constrained by temporal limitations. This can be achieved while engaging in other activities. However, a different method of performing *dhikr* entails allocating a brief period of time for this purpose. The individual assumes a seated position,

engages in *dhikr*, and directs their attention to their internal emotional and sensory experiences, thereby facilitating a profound sense of remembrance of the divine grandeur. This method bears a striking resemblance to the mindfulness technique.

2. The Relevance of *Ṣalāh* and Meditation

According to Islamic belief, *ṣalāh* is considered the most significant act of worship for Muslims. Following their profession of faith in Islam, individuals are commanded to perform *ṣalāh* as a demonstration of their religious conviction. Prayer functions as a conduit that facilitates communication between Allah and His servants. Moreover, prayer confers a multitude of benefits on humanity, including its role in physical exercise, which is conducive to physical health, enhances blood circulation, and fosters mental tranquility, thus serving as a valuable method for self-healing.

The phenomenon of a correlation between prayer and meditation methods can be attributed to the similarity of brain wave conditions. Electrical activities in the brain manifest as brain waves, resulting from the communication between neurons. The electromagnetic spectrum of the human brain comprises five distinct types of waves: gamma, beta, alpha, theta, and delta.⁴⁴

It has been demonstrated that, among these five distinct waves, an individual who engages in prayer with profound dedication experiences a state in which the brain exhibits a transition between the alpha and theta waves. In a similar manner, during the practice of meditation, an individual's brain waves will oscillate between the alpha and theta bands. In the field of psychology, the phenomenon of brain waves has been shown to correspond with the state of maximal relaxation in the body.⁴⁵

Furthermore, Muharini Aulia elucidated the correlation between prayer and meditation, positing that both practices occlude all senses from external stimuli, compelling the individual to momentarily

⁴⁴ Rosmawati, *The Miracle*, 65.

⁴⁵ Podcastren, "Psikologi Salat: Salat Khusus Bikin Rileks | Ustadzah Muharini Aulia | Filosofi Salat", video YouTube, 18 Januari 2022, <https://youtu.be/TRk0h7AuuPQ>.

amalgamate their consciousness and focus on a solitary object. At this stage, individuals are encouraged to engage in introspection and self-reflection.

3. The Relevance of Patience and Forgiveness

Patience can be defined as the ability to exercise self-control in order to act in a manner that is beneficial to oneself and to others. In the field of psychology, patience is defined as the capacity to respond initially in an active manner, characterized by the restraint of emotions, thoughts, words, and behavior in challenging or rewarding circumstances. This notion is predicated on the principle of achieving positive outcomes while adhering to established norms.⁴⁶

The concept of patience is multifaceted, encompassing various psychological dimensions. Firstly, the necessity of self-control is paramount. A patient individual endeavors to exercise restraint and self-control, thereby maintaining a course of conduct that aligns with ethical principles. One of these is to cultivate emotional restraint and regulate emotions in a more effective manner, thereby fostering stability. Secondly, the determination to persevere in the face of adversity. It has been demonstrated that individuals who exercise patience are able to summon the fortitude to exert greater effort in the face of adversity and demonstrate perseverance in the face of challenges. Thirdly, sincerity and acceptance of reality are paramount. An individual who embodies patience is capable of maintaining sincerity in all matters and endeavors to embrace the destiny that Allah has divinely decreed for their existence.⁴⁷

Fourthly, the concept of forgiveness. It is evident that an individual who has genuinely accepted reality and their destiny will also possess the capacity to forgive. The fifth component is characterized by composure. Patience has been demonstrated to foster a more composed personality and character. Individuals who exhibit

⁴⁶ Ibu Profesional ASIA, "UTS#1: Psikologi, Sabar, dan Perempuan", video YouTube, 2 Oktober 2021, <https://www.youtube.com/live/kSv0r816atM?feature=share>.

⁴⁷ Subandi, "Sabar: Sebuah Konsep Psikologi," *Jurnal Psikologi* 38, no. 2 (2011), 220-221, DOI: <https://doi.org/10.22146/jpsi.7654>.

patience tend to exercise greater caution in their actions and verbal communications. Sixthly, it is prudent to consider the implications of this phenomenon. Individuals who exhibit patience in the face of adversity tend to engage in meticulous and rational problem-solving, characterized by a systematic and methodical approach. The seventh characteristic that was identified is a persistent and unyielding attitude. It is imperative to exercise patience, as it has been demonstrated that individuals who do so will rapidly recuperate and reestablish their zeal. They will endeavor to identify methodologies for ameliorating and surmounting the challenging circumstances they are confronting.⁴⁸

As demonstrated above, patience is a multifaceted psychological concept. This demonstrates the efficacy of patience in all circumstances, underscoring its numerous benefits for the individual. Furthermore, patience has been demonstrated to have a significant impact on an individual's mental and emotional well-being. This is due to the fact that patience enables an individual to exercise self-control and maintain emotional stability.

When linked to the psychological method of self-healing, patience is closely related to forgiveness. It is an inherent quality of the human condition that individuals who are able to exercise patience will invariably be capable of self-forgiveness in the face of their transgressions. This capacity stems from the recognition that it is a futile endeavor to engage in self-blame or self-loathing in response to the inevitable challenges and missteps that characterize the human experience. Furthermore, individuals have been shown to be willing to forgive others who have caused them harm.

4. The Relevance of *Shukr* and Gratitude

Gratitude is a psychological technique for self-healing that involves the expression of gratitude. In the field of psychology, gratitude is defined as an individual's cognitive orientation toward the benefits received.⁴⁹ Gratitude has been identified as a mechanism for

⁴⁸ Ibid., 221-222.

⁴⁹ Rosmawati, *The Miracle of Self*, 204

healing emotional wounds and as a strategy for maintaining mental health, given its capacity to engender positive emotions within the individual. In the field of psychology, the practice of gratitude encompasses a variety of approaches, including the maintenance of a gratitude journal. This journaling practice involves the documentation of individuals who have exerted a positive influence on the writer's life. Furthermore, it is possible to articulate this sentiment explicitly by expressing gratitude to the individual in question.

In Islam, gratitude is considered an integral component of the worship of Allah, manifesting as an expression of profound appreciation for all facets of existence. The expression of gratitude can be articulated through various channels, including but not limited to one's heart, tongue, and other physical components.⁵⁹ Consequently, gratitude can be expressed in a variety of ways and forms. The practice of gratitude in Islam entails both contemplative and expressive dimensions. On the one hand, it involves reflecting on the blessings bestowed upon individuals by Allah, either internally or in the form of verbal expression. This contemplation can manifest in the recitation of words of praise, such as "*taḥmīd*," which conveys gratitude to the divine entity that grants blessings. Furthermore, the expression of gratitude can be manifested through the involvement of additional bodily functions, such as the consumption of purchased food, the judicious use of financial resources, the allocation of a portion of one's salary to charitable causes, and the heightened commitment to spiritual devotion as a means of expressing gratitude for the gift of a functional and well-maintained body.

The method or technique of gratitude has been shown to have similarities with the concept of gratitude in Islam. Gratitude and *syukur* are interconnected, with *shukr* representing an analogous sentiment to gratitude, characterized by profound appreciation for positive occurrences. Furthermore, it has been demonstrated that these two methods of self-healing elicit a similar effect, characterized by an increased prevalence of positive emotions.

⁵⁹ Al-Fawzan, *Kayfa Nakūna*, 14.

Concluding Remarks

The present article posits that Hamka's notion of self-healing is inextricably linked to spiritual practices aimed at fortifying the bond with Allah. In his *Tafsir Al-Azhar* interpretation, Hamka underscores four predominant forms of spiritual exercise as conduits for inner healing: *dhikr*, *ṣalāh*, patience, and *shukr*. *Dhikr*, for instance, has been demonstrated to be directly associated with peace of mind, as evidenced by the following verse from Surah al-Ra'd [13]: 28. Furthermore, *ṣalāh*, according to Hamka's interpretation of Surah al-Baqarah [2]: As indicated in 45 and al-Mu'minūn [23]: 2, the performance of the ritual with devotion has the potential to serve as a means of purifying the soul. Patience and *shukr* are postulated to cultivate positive mental states, characterized by the expansion of the soul and the attenuation of negative emotions, thereby engendering a state of inner tranquility.

Interestingly, Hamka's self-healing approach has significant overlap with concepts in contemporary psychology. The practice of *dhikr*, for example, is similar to the mindfulness method, which emphasizes full awareness of the present moment. Similarly, *ṣalāh* in Islamic spirituality has similarities with meditation, particularly in terms of their ability to stabilize brain waves and create deep focus. Patience, from a psychological perspective, is closely related to the concept of forgiveness, also known as an emotional healing technique. Meanwhile, the attitude of *shukr* taught by Hamka aligns with the concept of gratitude in positive psychology, which also significantly contributes to mental health.

Consequently, Hamka's perspective on self-healing is not only firmly rooted in theology but also harbors the capacity to foster a constructive dialogue between Islamic spirituality and contemporary scientific psychological methodologies. This finding presents a foundation for the development of an integrative approach to inner healing, which addresses both emotional and cognitive aspects while also strengthening the spiritual dimension of human beings. Amidst a global mental health crisis, Hamka's philosophy underscores the

potential of religious values to serve as a substantial reservoir for fostering the growth and resilience of the soul.

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